Competition environment

Visual
- Lighting
  - Brightness (dim / bright)
  - Direction (front / side / back) -> different shadows on stickers
  - Color temperature (warm/yellow vs cold/blue)
  - Flicker (some LEDs / venues)
  - Glare / reflections
  - Mixed sources (daylight + ceiling lights)
- Peripheral motion
  - People walking behind/around you
  - Hands entering peripheral (judge / runner / scrambler)
  - Moving shadows (projector, fan, people)
  - Scoreboard animations / screens changing
- Visual clutter
  - Banners, posters, bags, piles of gear on tables
  - Multiple stations in view
  - Bright clothing passing by
- Distance & perspective
  - Table height changes eye angle to the cube
  - Sitting distance to timer/mat varies
  - Open space / stage-like placement feels exposed
- Focus disruptors
  - Cameras / tripods / phones pointed at you
  - Flash / autofocus assist lights
  - Someone leaning in close to watch your hands
- Legibility
  - Sticker contrast changes under venue light
  - Dust/grease affects visual clarity
  - Cover glare (if cover is glossy/transparent)

Audio
- Continuous background
  - Crowd murmur
  - HVAC hum
  - Echo / reverb (large halls)
  - Constant cube turning sounds from other stations
- Unpredictable spikes
  - Claps / cheers
  - Loud laugh / shout
  - Dropped chair / object
  - Bag zipper, chair scrape
  - Timer beep nearby
  - Table knocks / bumps
- Structured noise
  - PA announcements (groups, scramblers needed, etc.)
  - Runners calling names
  - Judge prompts ("Ready?")
- Close-proximity speech
  - Whispering near you
  - Judge talking to someone
  - Friends commenting nearby
- Self-audio
  - Your breathing becomes loud under stress
  - Cube turning volume feels different in quiet moments

Physical / tactile
- Furniture
  - Chair height mismatch
  - Chair wobble / no back support
  - Armrests interfere with elbows
  - Table height mismatch
  - Table wobble
  - Mat slipping
- Posture & body configuration
  - Elbows supported vs floating
  - Leaning forward vs upright
  - Feet planted vs dangling
- Surface feel
  - Mat texture changes (friction)
  - Timer/mat alignment slightly off-center
  - Edge of table position vs your forearms
- Air & climate
  - Cold AC draft on hands
  - Heat
  - Humidity -> sweat -> grip changes
  - Dry air -> dry skin
- Proximity
  - Judge sitting very close (personal space)
  - Neighbor station too close (crowding)
- Micro-discomforts
  - Badge/lanyard annoyance
  - Wristband/sleeves catching
  - Tight clothing restricting leg position
  - Dry eyes under AC

Procedure / routine
- Pre-solve flow (WCA mechanics)
  - Filming yourself
  - Cube arrives covered (or you cover it)
  - Judge prompt ("Ready?") + your response gesture
  - Uncover -> inspection starts
  - Hands on pads, wait, start
  - Stop, confirm, release
- Scramble handling
  - Someone else scrambles (variance)
  - Cube handed to you (orientation surprise)
  - Cover placement/removal friction
- Scorekeeping
  - Judge writes time
  - You verify time/penalties
  - You sign the scorecard
  - Penalty/DNF discussion nearby creates tension
- Between solves
  - Mandatory waiting
  - Station changes
  - Runner interruptions ("you're up")
  - "Don't touch cube" periods vs home habit of fiddling
- Rules pressure
  - Fear of procedural mistake (timer, inspection, stopping)
  - Judge corrections ("hands on pads", etc.)

Time & pacing
- Call-up unpredictability
  - You don't choose when the solve starts
  - Delays, schedule drift
  - Sudden "you're up now" startle cue
- Waiting blocks
  - Long idle time raises arousal
  - Sudden performance demand after waiting
  - Warmup availability varies (sometimes none)
- Limited attempts (scarcity)
  - Only 5 solves
  - "First solve shock"
  - "Last solve desperation"
- Round constraints
  - Cutoff awareness changes behavior
  - Time-limit awareness changes risk tolerance
  - Group order (early vs late) changes arousal

Social / observation
- Being watched
  - Strangers watching
  - Friends/family watching
  - Rivals watching
  - Camera viewers (livestream)
  - Judge as evaluator (silent note-taking)
- Social comparison
  - Hearing other times announced
  - Seeing someone PB or fail nearby
- Reputation layer
  - "People expect X from me"
  - Identity threat ("I'm the fast guy / WR guy")
- Interaction friction
  - Small talk right before solves
  - People asking questions mid-round

Information environment
- Ambiguity
  - Unclear schedule
  - Confusing group calls
  - Uncertainty about when you'll solve next
- Attention fragmentation
  - Monitoring announcements while trying to stay warm/ready
  - Switching between "waiting mode" and "perform mode"
- Navigation
  - Moving between tables/rooms changes state
  - Carrying gear, finding seat, losing "home base"

Equipment variability
- Timer & station
  - Different timer model / pad sensitivity
  - Timer angle and viewing angle differ
  - Mat size and placement vary
  - Table edge position varies
- Cube state
  - Cube choice (new vs broken-in)
  - Lube/feel changes with temperature/humidity
  - Tension slightly off
  - Magnets feel different in cold
- Accessories
  - Earplugs/noise-canceling changes perception
  - Finger tape/band-aids change tactile feedback

Psychology / framing
- Scarcity label
  - "These 5 solves matter"
  - "This scramble is special"
- Outcome fixation
  - Qualification / podium / PR
  - Avoiding embarrassment
- Error interpretation
  - One slip becomes a story -> spiral into next solves
- Control illusion
  - Home = full control
  - Comp = surrender control -> threat response
- Attention mode
  - Automatic execution vs conscious micromanagement
  - Finger tricks become manual under pressure

Physiology (internal environment)
- Arousal
  - Elevated HR from walking/rushing
  - Adrenaline -> shaky hands (over-activation)
- Fuel
  - Caffeine timing (focus vs tremor)
  - Hunger / low blood sugar -> jittery
  - Hydration status
- Sleep / travel
  - Jet lag
  - Poor sleep
  - Early call time
- Thermal
  - Cold hands -> stiff turning
  - Warm hands -> sweat
- Warmup state
  - Too much warmup -> overthinking
  - No warmup -> shock

Unpredictability / failure modes
- Venue surprises
  - Chair too low
  - Table wobble
  - Lighting changes mid-round
  - Judge behavior differences (strict vs relaxed)
- Interruptions
  - Someone bumps the table
  - Runner taps you
  - Sudden announcement startle
- Recovery requirement
  - Must reset emotionally between solves fast
  - No instant redo (unlike home)

Presented with xmind